

Publications

(making it seem more impressive than it is because it's all I got)

- [1] **Hieu M Vu** and Tan Minh Nguyen. “Angular Steering: Behavior Control via Rotation in Activation Space”. In: *NeurIPS* (2025). **Spotlight (top 3.5%)**. Poster. ArXiv. Github.
- [2] Dung V Nguyen*, **Hieu M Vu***, Nhi Y Pham*, Lei Zhang, and Tan M Nguyen. “Activation Steering with a Feedback Controller”. In: *ICLR* (2026). ArXiv. Github.
- [3] Tuan-Anh D Nguyen, **Hieu M Vu**, Nguyen Hong Son, and Minh-Tien Nguyen. “A Span Extraction Approach for Information Extraction on Visually-Rich Documents”. In: *DIL @ ICDAR Workshops*. **Best Paper Award**. 2021.
- [4] Nguyen Hong Son, **Hieu M Vu**, Tuan-Anh D Nguyen, and Minh-Tien Nguyen. “Jointly Learning Span Extraction and Sequence Labeling for Information Extraction from Business Documents”. In: *IJCNN*. **Oral**. 2022.

Experience

(trying to up-sell myself)

Anthropic Fellow

Jan 2026 — May 2026

Anthropic Fellows Program (via MATS)

Berkeley, CA, USA

- Participated in the Anthropic Fellows Program via ML Alignment and Theory Scholars (MATS), worked on internal representation of un verbalized situational awareness.
- Implemented activation steering on Kimi K2.5 (1T parameters) on 8xH100; surveying evaluation awareness on open-weight models; decoupling the internal representations of evaluation awareness and verbalization in a eval-aware model organism.

Independent Researcher

June 2024 — Present

- Self-directed research on LLM interpretability, focusing on understanding and controlling the activation space.
- Developed *Angular Steering* (NeurIPS 2025 spotlight) [1] — an activation steering method for fine-grained and robust behaviour control of LLMs behaviours; integrated the method into vLLM.
- Visited the National University of Singapore (funded) to collaborate with Prof. Tan M. Nguyen on mathematically grounded activation steering methods [2].

AI Researcher/Engineer

July 2024 — Present

Torilab

- Researched activation steering methods for LLMs behaviour control [1].
- **Building AI avatars:** Developed the core chatbot framework with memory, tool use, and multi-turn interactions; LLM fine-tuning (SFT, DPO, GRPO) and serving (vLLM, SGLang).

AI Researcher/Engineer

Nov 2018 — May 2024

Cinnamon AI

- Co-creator of **kotaemon** (25.3k+ ★): An open-source tool for local RAG application built for both end users and developers.
- **Document Image Understanding:** Information Extraction and cross-lingual adaptive pre-training for Japanese. Introduced new IE models that became the standard for client projects (+2-7% f1-score) [3, 4].

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Aug 2017 — Sep 2019

IOT Lab, UET - Vietnam National University

- Predictive models for wellbore data: facies classification, time-series analysis, permeability regression, cumulative and federated learning.

Professional Services

Reviewer

ICML 2026, ICLR 2026, MoFA @ ICML 2025, XLLM-Reason-Plan @ COLM 2025

Teaching/Mentoring

Cinnamon AI Bootcamp 2020, 2022, 2023

- Mentored groups of 3-4 students.
- Designed syllabus, prepared entrance tests, interviewed candidates.
- Prepared materials and gave lectures on Language Modelling and Transformers.

Education

(grade is just a number and I got lucky)

Bachelor Degree, Computer Science (Honours Programme)

2020

UET - Vietnam National University, Hanoi

GPA: 3.83/4.00 (Rank: =1st/600+)

- Highest Ranking Graduate.

Honours and Awards

(more uncomfortably showing off)

Best Paper Award

Sep 2021

ICDAR 2021, Workshop on Document Images and Language

Paper title: [A Span Extraction Approach for Information Extraction on Visually-Rich Documents](#)

Accepted for oral presentation and awarded the Best Paper Award at Workshop on Document Images and Language, ICDAR 2021.

Certificate of Highest Ranking Graduate

Aug 2020

UET - Vietnam National University

Awarded to students who graduated with the highest GPA amongst the graduating class.

Top 4 Zalo AI Challenge 2018 - Voice Track (Individual participant)

Sep 2018

Zalo, VNG Corporation

Finished at 4th place on the Private Leaderboard of the Voice Gender/Accent Classification challenge.

[Zalo AI Challenge](#) is an annual Kaggle-like competition hosted by Zalo - one of the biggest tech companies in Vietnam. In 2018, the competition attracted over 700 teams competed in 3 challenges.

Skills

(for those bots that love keywords)

Technical Fields	LLMs, ML Interpretability, Activation Steering, RAG, Agentic AI, Information Extraction, Document Understanding, NLP, Computer Vision, Image Processing, Time-series Analysis.
ML/AI Tools	Pytorch, Transformers, vLLM, sglang, LangChain, Haystack, LlamaIndex, Tensorflow/Keras, Scikit-learn, OpenCV.
Software Development	Git, Github Action, Docker, CircleCI, DVC.
Programming Languages	Python, C/C++, Java, Shell Script.
Industrial Domains	Insurance, Manufacturing, Virtual Companion.
Environments	GCP, AWS, Linux, Windows/WSL.
Natural Languages	Vietnamese (native), English (IELTS 7.5), Japanese (JLPT N4).
Other	Research (Google Scholar), Problem Solving (Leetcode).

References

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